FACILITATOR GUIDE · LEARNER WORKBOOK · BUYER TOOLKIT
RAISE STANDARDS · BUILD TRUST · CREATE OWNERSHIP

The High-Performance Leadership System

A practical operating system for frontline leaders who need reliable execution without fear, burnout, or dependence on heroics.

1-DAY WORKSHOP10-VIDEO SERIES90-DAY REINFORCEMENT

Built for newly promoted managers, team leads, and organizations ready to turn strategy into observable daily behavior.

THE HIGH-PERFORMANCE LEADERSHIP SYSTEM

Buyer Executive Brief

THE BUYER PROBLEM

Inconsistent execution is rarely solved by another dashboard or a louder escalation. It is usually a management-system problem: standards are vague, authority is unclear, feedback arrives late, and managers either rescue the work or avoid the hard conversation.

This product gives leaders a shared language and a repeatable sequence: specify the outcome, create commitment, coach early, follow through fairly, and install routines that keep good work visible.

Commercial promise. Participants leave with tools they can use in their next 1:1, team meeting, delegation brief, and performance correction.

BEST-FIT BUYERS

- New-manager populations with uneven coaching confidence
- Service or operations teams where rework and escalation are rising
- Growth-stage firms outgrowing founder-led problem solving
- Organizations seeking a common management language

OUTCOMES TO MEASURE

Clarity of expectations, on-time delivery, quality or rework, escalations, employee confidence, manager practice completion, and relevant customer measures.

Essentials	10 videos, workbook, self-assessment, discussion guide	A scalable common language
Team rollout	Essentials + live practice labs + facilitation	Managers rehearse the hard conversations
Transformation	Team rollout + baseline, coaching circles, 90-day measurement	Behavior change tied to operating metrics

Buyer discovery question

“Where does performance currently depend on a manager noticing, rescuing, or escalating work that the team should be able to own?” Use the answer to select the first team friction point.

Evidence base: Edmondson (1999); Locke & Latham (2002); Hattie & Timperley (2007); Deci, Olafsen & Ryan (2017); Gallup (2024). Full references at the end.

The Operating Premise: Standards × Warmth

High performance is not a tradeoff between demanding results and treating people well. Sustainable performance requires both. **Standards** make outcomes, quality, timing, decision rights, and consequences explicit. **Warmth** means respect, curiosity, fairness, recognition, support, and a credible belief that people can succeed.

Directive pressure
Short-term compliance; hiding problems; fear of bad news.

High-performance leadership
Clear commitments; early feedback; ownership; durable results.

Disengaged management
Confusion; low energy; drifting priorities.

Comfortable drift
Good intent; weak follow-through; uneven quality.

MANAGER TEST

Can each person state what good looks like, what they can decide, how progress is checked, and what to do when blocked?

TEAM TEST

Can someone surface a risk early without being blamed, and can the manager still hold the line on the agreed standard?

“High warmth is not lowering the bar. It is making success more possible and feedback more usable.”

Evidence base: Edmondson (1999); Locke & Latham (2002); Hattie & Timperley (2007); Deci, Olafsen & Ryan (2017); Gallup (2024). Full references at the end.

Why This System Works: Research to Practice

This program translates established evidence into manager behaviors. It does not present research as decoration: each finding changes a conversation, routine, or measurement practice.

Specific, challenging goals improve performance when feedback and commitment are present (Locke & Latham, 2002).	“Do your best” is insufficient. Standards must be observable.	Use CLEAR: Concrete outcome, Level of quality, Evidence, Authority, Rhythm.
Psychological safety supports speaking up and learning (Edmondson, 1999).	Managers need bad news early, not false reassurance.	Ask before telling; separate facts from labels; thank people for surfacing risk.
Feedback is strongest when it addresses task, process, and self-regulation rather than personality (Hattie & Timperley, 2007).	“Be more proactive” is weak feedback.	Use FACT: Facts, Ask, Clarify, Test the next action.
Autonomy, competence, and relatedness support internal motivation (Deci et al., 2017).	Ownership cannot be demanded by slogan.	Delegate outcomes with decision rights, guardrails, and coaching.

Facilitator note: Ask participants to challenge the evidence against a real example. “What behavior would change on Monday if we took this seriously?” This prevents theory from becoming a compliance exercise.

Reflection

Name one current management practice that produces short-term compliance but weak learning. What would you replace it with?

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Diagnostic: Your Pressure Pattern

Under pressure, managers tend to repeat a default pattern. The diagnostic is not a personality test. It is a prompt for choosing a more useful response before pressure makes the choice for you. Score each statement: 1 = rarely true, 3 = sometimes true, 5 = often true.

I take work back when a deadline is at risk.	____	Rescuing; weak ownership or unclear guardrails
I soften or postpone a difficult performance conversation.	____	Avoidance; warmth without standards
I become more directive and explain less.	____	Pressure; standards without curiosity
I assume people know what “good” means.	____	Ambiguous standards
I inspect activity but do not discuss decision rights.	____	Control rather than accountability

I recognize effort more often than specific behavior.	____	Weak reinforcement loop
I ask for updates but do not agree a next action.	____	Meetings without commitments
I only hear about a problem after it is urgent.	____	Low safety or weak operating rhythm

INTERPRETATION

Circle your two highest items. They are your **pressure pattern**, not your identity. Identify the triggering condition, the cost to the team, and one replacement behavior.

PAIR DEBRIEF PROMPT

“When I am under pressure, my team experiences me as ____. The standard I want to preserve is ____. The warmth behavior I will add is ____.”

Commitment

In the next seven days, I will notice this trigger: _____ and replace my default response with: _____.

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Module 1: The Cost of Unclear Leadership

Purpose: Create urgency without blaming managers. Teams do not become inconsistent because people lack effort alone. They become inconsistent when outcomes, ownership, feedback, and decision rights are fuzzy.

Teach: Separate activity, output, and outcome. “Attend more client meetings” is activity. “Send a follow-up” is output. “Every qualified opportunity has a tailored next step within one business day” is an outcome standard that can be observed and improved.

Facilitation flow (25 minutes): Open with a familiar friction: a customer waits, work returns for rework, or a decision travels through three people. Ask learners to locate the unclear element. Was the outcome unknown? Was the quality bar undefined? Was authority absent? Was follow-up missing?

Debrief: Do not accept “they need to be more accountable” as a diagnosis. Ask, “Accountable for what, by when, with what evidence, and with what authority?”

Watch-out: This is not an invitation to over-specify every task. The system clarifies the minimum needed for good judgment, then gives people room to act.

Repeated rework	Quality standard is implicit	Show one strong and one acceptable example; agree evidence.
Late surprises	Risks are punished or escalation path is unclear	Ask for risks at a fixed weekly point; thank early disclosure.
Manager bottleneck	Authority sits with the manager	Name decisions the owner can make without approval.
Status meetings with no movement	No commitment or review rhythm	End each discussion with owner, action, date, and check-in.

Practice: 15-minute friction map

Choose one recurring friction. Describe the expected outcome, current behavior, cost to customer/capacity, and the manager action that would clarify, enable, or inspect it.

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Worksheet: Performance Friction Map

Use this worksheet on one real team problem. Work from observable evidence. The goal is not to assign blame; it is to find the leadership-system condition that makes the gap repeat.

1. What must be true when this work is done well?
2. What is happening instead? Include facts, dates, examples, or data.
3. What is the impact on customer, colleague, cost, risk, or capacity?
4. Which element is unclear: outcome, quality, evidence, authority, rhythm, skill, resource, or incentive?
5. What will the manager clarify, enable, inspect, or reinforce this week?
6. What measure or evidence will show progress by the next review?

Facilitator instruction: In triads, give each person four minutes to describe the friction, four minutes for peers to ask only diagnostic questions, then four

minutes to state a manager experiment. The listener must not solve the problem before the evidence is clear.

Useful diagnostic question: “If a capable new hire joined tomorrow, could they discover the expected standard and escalation path without reading the manager’s mind?”

Case Study 1: The Aurora Service Desk

Situation. Aurora’s 14-person service desk has a 91% first-response target. The target has slipped to 76% for two months. The manager, Priya, reviews the queue twice daily and often reassigns tickets herself. Her team says they are “doing their best,” while customers report inconsistent updates.

What you can observe. A sample of 40 tickets shows that 18 lacked a next update date, 11 were assigned to specialists without a customer-facing owner, and 9 sat blocked for more than one day. Priya has not defined when agents can re-prioritize work or escalate resource conflicts. In meetings, she asks, “Can we all be more on top of this?”

Priya	“I have to jump in or customers wait.”	Rescuing temporarily protects the metric but hides the system gap.
Senior agent	“I do not want to step on anyone’s toes.”	Decision rights are unclear.
New agent	“I was waiting for the specialist.”	No standard for proactive customer update or blocked-work escalation.
Customer	“I can handle a delay; I cannot handle silence.”	Quality includes communication, not just resolution.

Team task

Diagnose the primary gap. Draft one CLEAR standard for ticket ownership. Identify one warmth behavior Priya must use so that early escalation becomes safe rather than punitive.

Case Study 1 Debrief: From Rescue to Ownership

Diagnosis. Aurora does not principally have an effort problem. It has a standard, authority, and rhythm problem. Priya’s rescue behavior teaches agents that ownership ends at the queue boundary. Her vague request for people to be “more on top of it” gives no executable agreement.

Concrete outcome	Every open customer ticket has a named customer-facing owner and a next update date.
Level of quality	Customers receive an accurate update within one business day, even when another team owns the technical fix.
Evidence	Queue audit checks owner and next-update fields at 10:00 and 15:00; weekly sample checks message quality.
Authority	Agents may re-prioritize within their tier and request specialist help; team lead resolves cross-tier conflict.
Rhythm	Blocked tickets are raised in the 15-minute daily risk review; unresolved blocks escalate after one business day.

PRIYA’S NEW OPENING

“We missed the response standard. I own the lack of clarity here. From today, each ticket has one customer owner and a next update date. What will make that difficult, and what authority do you need to make it work?”

WHAT NOT TO DO

Do not announce a new rule, then continue privately reassigning tickets. That would keep the old system alive. Coach the owner in public routines; correct gaps privately and quickly.

Measure after 30 days: first response, percent of tickets with an update date, blocked-ticket age, repeat contacts, and agent clarity pulse.

Module 2: Make Standards Executable with CLEAR

A standard is executable when a person can act on it without guessing what the manager has in mind. CLEAR converts an aspiration into a visible agreement.

C · Concrete outcome	What must happen?	Every qualified opportunity receives a tailored follow-up.

L · Level of quality	What is acceptable, and what is excellent?	Reference the conversation and propose a relevant next step.
E · Evidence	How will we verify progress or completion?	Log next action and date in the CRM.
A · Authority	What decisions can the owner make?	Offer approved options; involve manager only for exceptions.
R · Rhythm	When do we check, and how do we escalate?	Within one business day; blocked decisions raised after two days.

Teaching narrative: Clarity is an act of respect. It reduces hidden rules, protects fairness, and lets managers distinguish a skill gap from a motivation or resource problem. The objective is not surveillance. Evidence creates a shared reality from which the employee can learn and the manager can coach.
Practice prompt

Rewrite: “Improve customer follow-up.” Then test it: could two reasonable people tell whether it happened, whether it was good enough, and what to do if blocked?

Facilitator timing: 12-minute teach, 15-minute individual rewrite, 18-minute peer test, 10-minute harvest.

CLEAR Practice Lab: Weak to Workable

Use the table to turn ambiguous manager language into an agreement that a capable person can execute. Add context, not bureaucracy.

“Own the handover.”	Can we observe the outcome and name decision rights?
“Be more proactive.”	Does it describe a behavior rather than a trait?
“Improve quality.”	Is acceptable quality illustrated or evidenced?
“Keep stakeholders informed.”	Does it specify rhythm and escalation?

PEER COACH QUESTIONS

- What exactly will be different?
- What evidence will prove it?
- Where can the owner decide?
- What risk warrants escalation?

FACILITATOR SCORING

0 = aspiration only. 1 = outcome named. 2 = outcome plus quality/evidence. 3 = full CLEAR agreement, with realistic authority and rhythm.

Transfer assignment: Before the next session, test one CLEAR standard in a real conversation. Bring the employee’s clarifying questions to the cohort. Questions reveal where the original standard still relied on manager assumptions.
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Module 3: Create Commitment, Not Compliance

Managers need to set direction. Yet direction alone rarely creates ownership. Commitment comes when people understand the why, contribute their view of reality, know their authority, and can state the agreement in their own words.

1. State outcome and why	“We need accurate proposal handoffs because customers experience our teams as one company.”	Connects the standard to purpose and customer impact.
2. Ask for current reality	“What would make this difficult this week?”	Surfaces constraints before they become excuses or surprises.
3. Agree standard and authority	“You can choose the handoff format; legal exceptions come to me.”	Creates practical autonomy.
4. Ask for a playback	“How are you taking this forward?”	Tests shared understanding without a quiz.
5. Set rhythm and support	“What support do you need, and when will we review the first two?”	Converts intention into a managed commitment.

Facilitator demonstration: Role-play a 90-second compliance conversation, then repeat it as a commitment conversation. Ask observers what changed in employee voice, risk discovery, and clarity.
Manager preparation

For a live expectation conversation: outcome _____; why it matters _____; question I will ask _____; decision rights _____; evidence/date _____.

Sample Dialogue: The Commitment Conversation

Context: Marcus, a team lead, needs Elena to improve weekly account-risk updates. The old instruction was “keep the account team in the loop.”

Marcus	“Elena, I want to set a clearer standard for account risks. When we learn about a risk late, the customer gets mixed messages. By 3 p.m. each Thursday, I need a short update on every amber or red account: risk, owner, next action, and any decision needed.”	States outcome, quality, and why.
Elena	“Some owners do not respond by then. I end up chasing them.”	Brings constraint into the open.
Marcus	“What would let you move it without waiting indefinitely?”	Uses curiosity, not blame.
Elena	“If I can mark the owner as unconfirmed and tag their lead by noon, I can still send the update.”	Proposes a workable authority path.
Marcus	“Yes. Do that. You decide the status based on evidence; tag me only if an executive customer decision is needed. Walk me through how you will run this Thursday.”	Names authority and asks playback.
Elena	“I will request inputs Tuesday, send a noon reminder Thursday, then publish the update at 3 p.m. with unconfirmed items visible.”	Commits to a rhythm.

Observer checklist: Did the manager explain why, elicit reality, define authority, seek playback, and agree a review? Which phrase protected both standards and warmth?

Module 4: Coach the Gap Early with FACT

Early correction is kinder and more effective than accumulated frustration. FACT keeps the manager out of labels and the employee out of defensiveness.

F · Facts	Describe observable behavior and impact, not a character judgment.	“Three client updates were sent after the agreed date.”
A · Ask	Invite the person’s perspective before assuming cause.	“What got in the way?”
C · Clarify	Restate the standard and why it matters.	“The standard is same-day updates because silence creates avoidable uncertainty.”
T · Test	Agree next action, support, and check-in.	“What will change this week, what support is needed, and when will we review?”

FACT IS NOT SOFT

It is specific, timely, and follows through. Curiosity does not erase the standard. It helps a manager distinguish ambiguity, capability, capacity, or will before choosing the right intervention.

FACT IS NOT A SCRIPT

Use natural language. A manager who mechanically asks questions while avoiding the consequence still teaches that standards are optional.

Escalation logic: First confirm the agreement and remove barriers. If the same gap persists, state the impact, reset the corrective action, explain consequences consistent with policy, document the agreement, and follow up.

Evidence base: Edmondson (1999); Locke & Latham (2002); Hattie & Timperley (2007); Deci, Olafsen & Ryan (2017); Gallup (2024). Full references at the end.

Coaching Practice Lab and Observer Rubric

Scenario: A project coordinator missed two internal handoffs and did not flag the risk until the deadline day. The employee says, “I was overwhelmed and did not want to bother anyone.” Run a five-minute conversation, then rotate.

Facts	Uses labels or hearsay	Some examples, unclear impact	Specific observable facts and impact
Ask	Assumes motive	Asks one closed question	Invites perspective and listens
Clarify	Vague standard	Standard stated without why	Clear standard, rationale, and authority
Test	No next step	Action but no review	Action, support, evidence, and date
Warmth	Cold or rescuing	Respectful but passive	Respectful, candid, and confident
Follow-through	Avoids consequence	Hints at consequence	Names proportional next step/policy path

Debrief questions

What did the manager learn only because they asked? Which part of the agreement was missing before the gap? What response would reduce the likelihood of late surprise next time?

Second round twist: The employee has the skill and resources, but repeats the behavior after two clear agreements. Practice a firmer accountability conversation without changing the tone to punishment.

Case Study 2: The Product Launch That Slipped

Situation. A product team missed an internal launch by three weeks. The launch manager, Sam, says every workstream lead reported “on track” until the final ten days. In the retrospective, people blame a designer who changed the onboarding flow late. The designer says she had raised usability concerns twice but felt the group wanted momentum.

Status reports use green/amber/red but require no written risk, owner, or decision needed.	Colors conceal different realities; no evidence standard.
The weekly meeting spends 35 minutes on updates and five minutes on blockers.	Rhythm favors reporting over risk resolution.
Workstream leads ask Sam for approval on routine tradeoffs.	Authority is centralized; owners delay decisions.
The team praised “moving fast” but did not recognize early risk escalation.	Incentives may favor optimism over candor.

Leadership team task

Design a 20-minute weekly operating rhythm that surfaces risk early. Decide: What must each owner bring? What can they decide? What needs a group decision? How will early escalation be recognized?

Facilitator note: Participants often propose more tracking. Redirect them to fewer, sharper signals: commitment, evidence, risk, decision, owner, date.

Accountability Without Drama

Accountability is an agreement plus a follow-through process. It is not a surprise, a personality judgment, a public performance, or a manager’s release valve for frustration.

1. Reconfirm	Name the prior agreement.	“Last Tuesday we agreed each account would have a next action by Friday.”
2. Describe result	State observed outcome and impact.	“Six of twelve did not. That left the renewal team unable to plan.”
3. Ask	Learn what changed or was missed.	“What happened between the agreement and Friday?”
4. Correct	Set action, support, and date.	“Today we will complete the six; you will use the daily tracker through next Friday.”
5. Explain consequence	Where appropriate, explain the next formal step consistent with policy.	“If this repeats after the support we have agreed, we will move to our formal process.”
6. Document/follow up	Record the agreement and check it.	“I will send the summary; we meet Wednesday at 10.”

Guardrails: Stay private, factual, timely, and proportionate. Distinguish performance management from conduct, and follow organizational HR and legal policy. Do not promise outcomes or impose consequences outside your authority.

The credible manager does not surprise people with standards, and does not abandon standards when the conversation gets uncomfortable.

Sample Dialogue: Firm, Fair, and Forward

Context: After two FACT conversations, Jonah again failed to complete a required quality check. His manager, Mei, must be direct without shaming.

Mei: “Jonah, we agreed on September 8 that every release would include the quality check before handoff. The last two releases went forward without it, and we found three defects after deployment. Help me understand what changed.”

Jonah: “The deadline moved and I thought getting it out was more important.”

Mei: “I understand the deadline pressure. The quality check is not optional; it is part of a release. When timing conflicts, your authority is to pause the handoff and bring the tradeoff to me. For the next four releases, use the checklist and send it with the handoff. We will review after each one. If the agreed standard is missed again, we will move to the formal performance process. What is your understanding of the plan?”

Jonah: “I will not choose speed over the check. If I see a conflict, I will flag it before the handoff.”

Referenced a prior agreement and facts	No surprise; discussion starts from shared reality.
Acknowledged pressure without excusing the gap	Maintains warmth and standard simultaneously.
Clarified authority at the point of tradeoff	Removes a likely repeat cause.
Set temporary evidence and review rhythm	Creates support and accountability.
Named the next consequence calmly	Makes follow-through credible, not threatening.

Adapt

Rewrite Mei’s first two sentences for one real performance gap you need to address. Remove labels such as “careless,” “lazy,” or “not committed.”

Module 5: Delegate for Ownership

Delegation fails when managers hand over tasks but retain outcomes, decisions, and learning. Ownership grows when people understand the result, have meaningful control, receive appropriate guardrails, and can seek help without surrendering the work.

Outcome	What result must be true?	Giving a list of tasks with no purpose.
Guardrails	What must not be compromised?	“Use your judgment” with hidden constraints.
Authority	What decisions belong to the owner?	Requiring approval for routine choices.
Resources	What time, people, data, or budget are available?	Assigning work without capacity.
Risks	What warrants escalation, and when?	Only hearing about a problem when it is urgent.
Review date	When will we learn, adjust, or close?	Checking constantly or disappearing entirely.
Definition of done	What evidence confirms completion?	Arguments about whether work is finished.

Manager mindset shift: If you solve every hard problem, you create relief today and dependence tomorrow. If you delegate without clarity or support, you create anxiety and avoidable failure. Good delegation is a development intervention and an operating agreement.

Delegation brief

Pick one task you are tempted to keep. What outcome could another person own? What decision rights would make the delegation real?

Worksheet: Delegation Brief

Use this brief before a delegation conversation. It is designed to make ownership visible without over-controlling the method.

Outcome and why it matters

Definition of done / evidence

Non-negotiable guardrails

Decisions the owner can make

Decisions to escalate and trigger

Resources, stakeholders, and constraints

First review date and rhythm

Capability stretch: what will this person learn?

MANAGER CLOSE

“What do you understand the outcome to be? Which decisions will you make? Where do you see risk? What support would help without taking this back from you?”

OWNER CLOSE

“I will know I am done when ____. I will escalate if ____. Our first review is ____.”

Recognition: Reinforce What You Want Repeated

Recognition is not a substitute for feedback or pay. It is a management signal: it tells the team which behaviors make standards real. Generic praise can feel pleasant but teaches little. Specific recognition connects behavior, impact, and value.

“Great job.”	“You raised the supplier risk on Tuesday, brought two options, and protected Friday’s customer commitment.”	Early escalation and solution ownership.
“Thanks for working hard.”	“Your handoff included the decision log and customer context; the receiving team started without rework.”	Quality and cross-team empathy.
“You are a star.”	“You coached Mia through the analysis instead of taking it back. She now owns the next review.”	Development and delegation.

Weekly ritual: In the team meeting, recognize one observable behavior aligned to the standard and one example of constructive risk escalation. Keep it brief, factual, and inclusive. Do not turn recognition into a popularity contest.

Practice

Write one sentence of recognition for a behavior you want repeated this month. Include: behavior _____, impact _____, standard/value _____.

Facilitator note: Ask participants how they might recognize quiet, invisible coordination work without rewarding overwork or individual heroics.

Module 6: Install the Weekly Operating Rhythm

Routines convert good leadership intent into a system. The goal is not more meetings. It is a short cadence where priorities, commitments, risks, decisions, and learning are visible before they become emergencies.

Daily or twice-weekly, 10–15 min	Coordinate work and remove immediate blockers	Priority shifts; blocked work; owner/date	Keep it operational; resolve offline where possible.
Weekly team rhythm, 30 min	Review commitments, quality, risk, and recognition	Scorecard; commitments; risks; decisions; win/learning	Ask owners to speak first; make decisions visible.
1:1 coaching, 25–40 min	Develop capability and address gaps early	Employee agenda; outcomes; FACT conversation; support	Coach, do not turn it into a status interrogation.
Monthly improvement review, 45–60 min	Spot recurring friction and adjust the system	Trend data; root causes; one improvement experiment	Focus on process and capability, not blame.

WEEKLY RHYTHM FLOW

1. Outcomes: What moved? → **2. Commitments:** What is due next? → **3. Risks:** What could prevent it? → **4. Decisions:** Who decides by when? → **5. Learning:** What standard or process changes? → **6. Recognition:** What behavior should repeat?

Use a visible board or simple shared document. The format matters less than the discipline: owner, evidence, next action, date.

Team Scorecard and Meeting Template

A team scorecard should be small enough to use, broad enough to prevent gaming one metric at the expense of the whole system. Select measures relevant to the team's purpose.

Outcome	On-time delivery or resolved work	____	____	____
Quality	First-pass acceptance; defect or rework rate	____	____	____
Customer	Response time; satisfaction; renewal risk	____	____	____
Flow	Blocked-work age; handoff delay	____	____	____
Capability	Practice completion; cross-training progress	____	____	____
Team health	Clarity / safety pulse	____	____	____

30-MINUTE AGENDA

1. 2 min: purpose and scorecard
2. 8 min: commitments and evidence
3. 8 min: risks and decisions
4. 6 min: improvement experiment
5. 3 min: recognition
6. 3 min: owner/date recap

MANAGER PROMPTS

"What is the evidence?" "What decision belongs with you?" "What risk are we not naming?" "What will be different by our next review?"

Do not use the scorecard to punish disclosure. If a metric turns red, reward the team for identifying the cause early and agreeing a credible recovery action.

30-Day Manager Implementation Calendar

The first month creates momentum by applying one tool each week to real work. Participants should not attempt to transform every process at once.

1 · Clarify	One CLEAR standard	Choose a recurring friction; define outcome, quality, evidence, authority, and rhythm; run one commitment conversation.	The written standard plus one employee question.
2 · Commit	Two ownership conversations	Use playback; define decisions and escalation triggers; revise language based on questions.	Two short notes: agreement, risk, support, review date.
3 · Coach	One FACT conversation	Address a live performance gap within 48 hours; distinguish facts from labels; agree next action.	What you learned, action, and evidence date.
4 · Systemize	One weekly rhythm	Install a 30-minute team cadence; add commitments, risks, decisions, and recognition.	Scorecard photo/export and one change to make next week.

Daily 5-minute reflection

What standard did I make clearer today? Where did I ask before telling? What did I take back that another person could own? What evidence did we agree? Who did I recognize specifically?

Accountability partner: Pair managers. Each sends a Friday message with one practice completed, one learning, and next week's action. The partner asks one question rather than offering a solution.

90-Day Reinforcement and Measurement Plan

Training changes language. Reinforcement changes routines. This plan creates repeated practice, observable evidence, and buyer-level visibility into whether the system is taking hold.

Days 0–30	Complete calendar; use tools in live work; join peer practice.	Confirm priority friction and baseline; remove structural blockers.	Practice completion; clarity pulse; initial operational baseline.

Days 31–60	Run coaching circles; review pressure patterns; improve weekly rhythm.	Review trends with manager cohort; recognize early wins.	On-time/quality trends; early-risk rate; manager confidence.
Days 61–90	Teach a peer; sustain scorecard; choose next capability gap.	Decide scale, support, or policy/process changes.	30/60/90 comparison; employee clarity/safety pulse; relevant customer measure.

MEASUREMENT LOGIC

Leading indicators: CLEAR agreements, coaching conversations, delegation briefs, meeting discipline → **Behavior indicators:** clarity, early escalation, decision ownership → **Operating outcomes:** delivery, quality, customer impact, capacity.

Interpret with care: Do not claim causation from one short period. Look for a consistent pattern: adoption of manager practices, employee experience shifts, then improvement in the operational measures the team can influence.

Facilitator Guide: Flagship One-Day Workshop

Audience: 20–30 frontline managers and team leads. **Room:** tables of four, visible wall space, projected timer, printed workbook. **Outcome:** each participant leaves with one real leadership-system experiment and a peer accountability partner.

09:00	Open and contract	Buyer context, norms, friction prompt	Establish relevance and psychological safety.
09:25	Standards × Warmth	Teach + pressure-pattern diagnostic	Name defaults without judgment.
10:20	Friction map	Individual work + triads	Turn vague concerns into system diagnosis.
11:15	CLEAR standards	Teach + rewrite lab	Produce one executable standard.
13:00	Commitment conversations	Demo + paired practice	Build ownership language.
14:15	FACT coaching	Teach + role-play rubric	Practice timely correction.
15:30	Accountability and delegation	Case + dialogue practice	Increase firmness and decision ownership.
16:30	Operating rhythm and 30-day plan	Scorecard build + commitments	Convert insight into repeatable routines.
17:00	Close	Partner commitment and sponsor message	Lock in next action and support.

Room norm: “Discuss real work, preserve confidentiality, and challenge the system before judging the person.” Keep examples anonymized.

Facilitator Notes: Practice, Inclusion, and Recovery

Before delivery: Ask the buyer for 2–3 anonymized friction examples, current language for performance management, and relevant operating measures. Tailor examples, but do not invent policies or promise formal HR guidance.

When participants say “we do not have time”: Acknowledge the constraint. Ask what rework, escalation, or manager rescue currently consumes. Position the rhythm as a replacement for low-value status traffic, not an additive bureaucracy.

When participants want scripts: Give language stems, then insist on natural phrasing. The manager must sound credible in their environment.

When someone describes a sensitive performance issue: Redirect to facts and process. Remind the group to follow local policy and seek HR support where required.

Inclusion practice: Avoid treating directness as one cultural style. Define directness as clear, respectful, evidence-based communication. Invite multiple ways to express warmth and challenge.

Energy recovery: After dense teaching, use pair rehearsals of 90 seconds each. Give observers one narrow criterion. Debrief patterns, not individual competence.

Vague diagnosis	“What would we observe if that were true?”	Labels becoming facts.
Low ownership	“What decision could move closer to the work?”	Hidden approval loops.
Avoided feedback	“What is the cost of waiting another week?”	Fear of conflict, unclear standard.
Over-control	“What evidence would let you step back safely?”	Manager need for certainty.

Virtual Delivery Design: Four 90-Minute Sessions

Virtual delivery works when it reduces lecture and protects rehearsal. Use a shared digital workbook, breakout pairs, visible timer, and a live commitment tracker.

1 · Diagnose and clarify	Standards × Warmth; Friction Map; CLEAR	Rewrite one standard; peer test	Run one CLEAR conversation.
2 · Create commitment	Conversation sequence; authority; playback	90-second expectation conversation	Document two commitments and questions received.
3 · Coach and follow through	FACT; accountability guardrails	Role-play with observer rubric	Use FACT on one live, timely gap.
4 · Systemize	Delegation; scorecard; 30-day plan	Build weekly rhythm; partner commitments	Run first rhythm and bring evidence.

VIRTUAL FACILITATION RULES

- Teach no more than 12 minutes without interaction.
- Use a shared artifact for every breakout.
- Give roles: manager, employee, observer.
- Harvest one pattern, not every answer.

TECHNICAL FALLBACK

If breakouts fail, use chat-based paired prompts and invite two volunteers to model. Keep the practice objective; do not fill the time with additional slides.

Buyer ROI Model: Build a Credible Case

Use this model to estimate value, not to make inflated promises. Select one or two operational levers where the buyer has reliable baseline data. Agree assumptions with the buyer and show sensitivity.

Reduced rework	Hours avoided per month × loaded hourly cost × capture rate	80 hrs × $55 × 50% = $2,200/month
Fewer escalations	Escalations avoided × average manager/specialist hours × cost	12 × 2.5 hrs × $70 = $2,100/month
Faster delivery	Work items accelerated × contribution or capacity value	Use buyer-validated unit value
Lower regrettable turnover	Avoided exits × replacement-cost assumption	Use conservative finance/HR estimate
Manager capacity	Hours no longer spent rescuing × loaded cost	20 hrs × $75 = $1,500/month

Illustrative annualized value: If a pilot captures $2,200 in rework reduction, $2,100 in escalation reduction, and $1,500 in manager capacity per month, the annualized gross value is **$69,600** before any retention or revenue effects. Compare with program and implementation cost; do not double-count overlapping benefits.

ROI formula

Net benefit = validated annual benefit − total program cost. ROI % = (net benefit ÷ total program cost) × 100. Payback months = total program cost ÷ monthly validated benefit.

Buyer Business Case and Pilot Design

Recommended pilot: one manager cohort in a team with a visible operating problem and enough stability to measure. Avoid a pilot during a major reorganization unless the buyer explicitly wants leadership support for that transition.

Cohort	15–30 managers, ideally connected to a common operating context	Creates peer practice and common measures.
Baseline	Capture 4 weeks of relevant performance data plus clarity/safety pulse	Creates a credible comparison point.
Sponsor role	Open the program, reinforce priorities, review 30/60/90 trends	Signals that practice matters beyond the workshop.
Manager time	One day or four 90-minute sessions plus weekly 20–30 minutes of	Protects transfer to live work.

	application	
Success threshold	Agree 2 practice measures + 1–2 operating measures in advance	Prevents retrospective goal shifting.

EXECUTIVE SPONSOR MESSAGE

“We are not asking managers to add performance pressure. We are asking them to create more clarity, earlier learning, and more ownership. We will measure the routines, not just attend the training.”

DISCOVERY QUESTIONS

Which teams feel the cost most? What would improve if risks were surfaced earlier? Which management behavior currently creates the biggest bottleneck? What data exists?

Microlearning Series: Learning Architecture

Each microlearning video solves one recognizable manager problem, teaches one model, shows one realistic application, and ends with a one-week behavior challenge. Keep sales messaging outside the teaching core.

1	Why Good Teams Underperform	7 min	Inconsistency is often a leadership-system problem.	Friction Map
2	Standards × Warmth	8 min	Demand and respect reinforce each other.	Self-assessment
3	Make Expectations CLEAR	9 min	Good performance must be observable.	CLEAR template
4	Commitment, Not Compliance	8 min	Ownership starts with dialogue and authority.	Conversation guide
5	Coach the Gap Early	9 min	FACT corrects without blame.	Prompt card
6	Accountability Without Drama	8 min	Follow-through is fair and specific.	Checklist
7	Delegate for Ownership	7 min	Delegate outcomes, authority, and guardrails.	Delegation brief
8	Recognize What You Want Repeated	6 min	Specific recognition shapes norms.	Recognition examples
9	The Weekly Operating Rhythm	8 min	Routines make performance repeatable.	Agenda + scorecard
10	Your 30-Day Leadership Reset	7 min	Apply the system to one real challenge.	Action plan

Learning sequence: Diagnose → clarify → commit → coach → follow through → delegate → reinforce → systemize. Do not rearrange the series into a collection of tips; the value is the connected operating system.

Video Production Guide: From Script to Shoot

Creative principle: Open with a recognizable manager moment, not a definition. Show the cost, teach one model, demonstrate the behavior, then issue a practice challenge.

Opening 0:00–0:30	Use a specific tension: late surprise, vague handover, manager rescue.	Viewer can recognize the situation in 10 seconds.
Teach 0:30–3:00	Use one model only; animate the 2×2, flow, or checklist.	No concept pile-up; plain-language explanation.
Demonstration 3:00–5:30	Show a bad version briefly, then an improved conversation.	Dialogue sounds natural; facts not labels.
Application 5:30–7:00	Walk through one realistic example and downloadable asset.	Viewer sees what to do next.
Challenge + next step	Give one behavior for the coming week; preview next video.	Challenge is observable and limited.

VISUAL SYSTEM

Use navy (#093A4D), teal (#0D5D68), and gold (#D2A247). Favor simple diagrams, on-screen phrases, and document close-ups. Avoid stock imagery that implies performance rather than showing the manager action.

TALENT DIRECTION

Speak as a practical manager coach, not a lecturer. Pause after questions. Make eye-line and voice warm; deliver standards plainly. Record alternate takes of each dialogue line for editing flexibility.

Video Script Template and Asset Checklist

Use this repeatable production template for each episode.

Hook	“Have you ever discovered a problem only when it was too late to fix easily?”	B-roll: queue, missed handoff, status board.
Name the problem	“The issue may not be effort. It may be an unclear leadership system.”	Title card and simple friction diagram.
Teach one model	Define the model in under 90 seconds.	Animated model; one highlighted term at a time.
Show it	Manager/employee scene: poor version then improved version.	Two-camera dialogue; captions.
Apply it	Work one realistic example through the tool.	Screen capture or annotated worksheet.
Challenge	“This week, use this on one recurring friction.”	Download CTA; next-episode card.

PRE-PRODUCTION CHECKLIST

- Buyer-approved examples and terminology
- Script reviewed for one clear takeaway
- Downloadable tool ready and branded
- Accessibility: captions, contrast, readable type

POST-PRODUCTION CHECKLIST

- Captions and transcript verified
- Model labels match workbook language
- Practice challenge is measurable
- Links, assets, and next-video cue tested

Product Assets, Sales Positioning, and Launch Copy

ONE-SENTENCE POSITIONING

A practical leadership system that helps managers raise standards, build trust, and create ownership without relying on fear, micromanagement, or heroics.

BUYER-FACING DESCRIPTION

When performance is inconsistent, most organizations respond with more meetings, escalation, or pressure. This program gives managers a better answer: clear standards, direct coaching, meaningful ownership, and operating rhythms that make great work easier to repeat.

INCLUDED ASSETS

- Facilitator guide and learner workbook
- Pressure-pattern self-assessment
- Friction Map, CLEAR, FACT, and delegation tools
- Role-play scenarios and observer rubrics
- Scorecard, 30-day calendar, 90-day measurement plan
- Buyer ROI model and video production kit

Landing page	Build managers your teams can trust and your business can rely on.	Book a buyer discovery conversation.
Sales call	Replace vague accountability with a system managers can use in their next conversation.	Choose a pilot friction and measurement plan.
Sponsor email	We will measure practice, clarity, and operating outcomes—not attendance alone.	Nominate the first cohort.
Video close	Try one behavior this week; download the tool and continue to the next module.	Access the workbook or cohort.

Ethical sales note: Position the program as a capability and operating-system intervention. Do not guarantee revenue, retention, or culture outcomes that depend on conditions beyond the program’s scope.

Capstone: Your Leadership System Canvas

Use this final canvas to connect the product to one real team condition. A strong plan is small, specific, and visible enough to review.

Priority friction to solve

CLEAR standard we will introduce

Commitment conversation: who / when

FACT conversation or coaching need

Delegation/decision right to shift

Weekly rhythm change

Leading evidence we will review

Outcome measure and 30-day target

Warmth behavior I will deliberately practice

Accountability partner and check-in date

Closing facilitator script: “High performance is not created by pressure alone. It is created when people know what matters, have the support and authority to act, receive direct feedback, and experience consistent follow-through. Your job is to make that environment real every day.”
APPENDIX · HIGH-PERFORMANCE LEADERSHIP SYSTEM

Appendix A: Detailed Case Studies 1–2

Read the situation, name the operating failure, prepare exact manager language, and compare with the debrief. Each case supports a 20-minute practice clinic.

1. THE FRIDAY ESCALATION CYCLE

Situation. A customer-support team has missed its same-day escalation target for three weeks. Priya notices only when a director forwards a Friday complaint. She takes over the queue, issues chat instructions, and stays late. Analysts say they were unsure which issues qualified and when they could escalate.

Manager move. This is an agreement failure, not only an effort failure. Priya sets a CLEAR standard: any issue blocking a customer response for two hours is tagged, assigned, and escalated to the named owner; analysts can trigger it without approval; risk is reviewed at 10:00 and 3:00. She opens with FACT: the facts, a genuine question about signals and dependencies, the standard, then a one-week test.

Facilitator debrief

A strong answer moves authority closer to the work and produces evidence before Friday. A weak answer says “be more proactive” or adds manager surveillance. Review qualifying cases tagged on time, time from block to escalation, and whether people surfaced risk early. **Practice prompt:** Write the opening two sentences and the evidence that will be reviewed next.

2. THE POLISHED BUT LATE LAUNCH

Situation. A product-marketing team produces excellent assets but misses internal launch dates. Marcus avoids challenge because the work is creative and people are stretched. Sales receives no enablement until two days after launch. Marcus asks everyone to “tighten project management.”

Manager move. Separate quality from reliability. Define the minimum viable asset set, approval owner, draft date, final date, and genuine blocker. Marcus states: “The launch kit was due Tuesday and sales received it Thursday. What made our plan unreliable?” Then the owner repeats a revised commitment with an early proof point.

Facilitator debrief

High-quality work is not a reason for hidden timing risk. Look for a smaller first deliverable, explicit approvals, and sales readiness as evidence. Do not accept “we did our best” as the operating standard. **Practice prompt:** Write the opening two sentences and the evidence that will be reviewed next.

APPENDIX · HIGH-PERFORMANCE LEADERSHIP SYSTEM

Appendix A: Detailed Case Studies 3–4

Read the situation, name the operating failure, prepare exact manager language, and compare with the debrief. Each case supports a 20-minute practice clinic.

3. THE NEW MANAGER WHO OVER-CHECKS

Situation. Luis checks every customer email before it leaves. Response time is slowing and experienced staff have stopped offering ideas. A past customer error makes Luis anxious. An employee asks to resolve routine billing disputes up to a stated limit.

Manager move. Use a delegation brief, not a blanket release. Specify outcome, compliance guardrails, decision limit, escalation examples, resources, and Friday review. Luis says: “You can decide within these guardrails. Bring the first two examples to our review.”

Facilitator debrief

A good response acknowledges the error history but refuses permanent bottlenecking. Measure cycle time, sampled decision quality, routine cases resolved without approval, and employee confidence in decision rights. **Practice prompt:** Write the opening two sentences and the evidence that will be reviewed next.

4. THE AVOIDED PERFORMANCE CONVERSATION

Situation. Dara has missed three documentation deadlines. Her manager Chen knows she is managing a family challenge and has covered the work twice. Other team members now reconstruct incomplete handoffs. Chen plans to say, “You need to be more committed.”

Manager move. Chen avoids labels. He says: “The last three handoffs were incomplete at the agreed deadline, and colleagues had to reconstruct the record. What has been getting in the way?” He listens for capacity or system barriers, clarifies the minimum standard, agrees a near-term test, names support and review date, and documents the agreement under policy.

Facilitator debrief

Empathy does not mean indefinite ambiguity. The observer should hear facts, a real question, a clear standard, and a follow-up. Formal performance action is handled through local policy if the pattern continues. **Practice prompt:** Write the opening two sentences and the evidence that will be reviewed next.

Appendix A: Detailed Case Studies 5–6

Read the situation, name the operating failure, prepare exact manager language, and compare with the debrief. Each case supports a 20-minute practice clinic.

5. THE HIGH PERFORMER WHO HOARDS DECISIONS

Situation. Ava resolves difficult technical issues quickly but keeps decisions her senior analysts could make. The team meets targets, but no one grows into a broader role. Ava says, “It is faster if I do it.”

Manager move. Name result and cost: “Your expertise protects customers; it also creates a single point of failure.” Establish a delegation ladder: observe, recommend, decide within guardrails, then teach another person. Pick two routine decision types and review samples weekly.

Facilitator debrief

The required shift is authority plus feedback, not abandonment. Measure decisions made at the intended level, sampled rework, analyst learning, and Ava’s time spent on exceptional work. **Practice prompt:** Write the opening two sentences and the evidence that will be reviewed next.

6. THE CROSS-FUNCTIONAL HANDOFF NOBODY OWNS

Situation. Implementation says Sales submits incomplete discovery notes. Sales says Implementation asks too late. Customers repeat context and projects start late. Leaders use the monthly meeting to defend their teams.

Manager move. Create a shared handoff standard: required fields, accountable role, acceptance criteria, timing, exception process, and a weekly defect review. Begin with customer impact, isolate the first failure, and run a two-week intake experiment with visible rejection reasons.

Facilitator debrief

This is system accountability, not a search for a guilty team. Measure complete-first-pass rate, time to acceptance, customer re-asks, and defects by reason. **Practice prompt:** Write the opening two sentences and the evidence that will be reviewed next.

Appendix A: Detailed Case Studies 7–8

Read the situation, name the operating failure, prepare exact manager language, and compare with the debrief. Each case supports a 20-minute practice clinic.

7. THE SILENT SAFETY RISK

Situation. Field technicians skip a final photo check to save time. Nobody reports it because the manager praises speed and reacts sharply to late-day issues. A technician says, “If I flag it, I become the problem.”

Manager move. Make reporting safe while retaining the standard: “The photo check is non-negotiable. I need to understand why it is skipped and what would let people raise a risk early.” Reset workflow, protect time, invite signals, and visibly thank the first person who surfaces a failure.

Facilitator debrief

Psychological safety enables standards. Look for a process change, a credible non-retaliation message, and follow-through when risk appears. **Practice prompt:** Write the opening two sentences and the evidence that will be reviewed next.

8. THE REMOTE TEAM WITH ENDLESS STATUS MEETINGS

Situation. A distributed team has added three status meetings because leaders do not trust work is moving. Updates are long, decisions defer, and priorities change midweek without explanation.

Manager move. Replace activity reporting with a visible board: outcome, owner, next evidence, blocker, decision required. In a 15-minute review, discuss only missed commitments, material risks, and decisions. Close with what changed, why, and who owns the next move.

Facilitator debrief

Remote work is not the issue. Invisible standards and unowned decisions are. Success is fewer meetings, faster blocker resolution, and better forecast accuracy. **Practice prompt:** Write the opening two sentences and the evidence that will be reviewed next.

Appendix B: Role-Play Scenarios 1–3

Triads: manager, employee or peer, observer. Four minutes for the first conversation, two minutes of feedback, then repeat with stronger language. Score behavior, not charisma.

1. MISSED SERVICE-LEVEL TARGET

Brief. Employee missed the response-time standard twice after a staffing change. Practice FACT and agree a recovery plan.

Opening	Labels or vague urgency	Some facts	Observable facts and impact without blame
Inquiry	Tells or rescues	Closed question	Invites perspective before deciding
Standard	“Do better”	Partly specific	CLEAR outcome, authority, and evidence
Commitment	No owner or date	Action but weak follow-up	Owner, action, date, and check-in
Warmth	Avoidant, cold, or overly reassuring	Respectful but uneven	Direct, respectful, confidence-building

Observer instruction

Score each criterion 1–5. Record one effective quote, one missed opportunity, and one exact retry sentence. Total: ____ / 25. A score below 18 requires a repeat attempt.

2. VAGUE DELEGATION

Brief. Manager asks a senior specialist to “own the rollout.” The specialist needs authority, guardrails, and review points.

Opening	Labels or vague urgency	Some facts	Observable facts and impact without blame
Inquiry	Tells or rescues	Closed question	Invites perspective before deciding
Standard	“Do better”	Partly specific	CLEAR outcome, authority, and evidence
Commitment	No owner or date	Action but weak follow-up	Owner, action, date, and check-in
Warmth	Avoidant, cold, or overly reassuring	Respectful but uneven	Direct, respectful, confidence-building

Observer instruction

Score each criterion 1–5. Record one effective quote, one missed opportunity, and one exact retry sentence. Total: ____ / 25. A score below 18 requires a repeat attempt.

3. QUALITY DEFECT AFTER A RUSH

Brief. An analyst shipped work with a known defect to meet a deadline. Practice standards without shaming.

Opening	Labels or vague urgency	Some facts	Observable facts and impact without blame
Inquiry	Tells or rescues	Closed question	Invites perspective before deciding
Standard	“Do better”	Partly specific	CLEAR outcome, authority, and evidence
Commitment	No owner or date	Action but weak follow-up	Owner, action, date, and check-in
Warmth	Avoidant, cold, or overly reassuring	Respectful but uneven	Direct, respectful, confidence-building

Observer instruction

Score each criterion 1–5. Record one effective quote, one missed opportunity, and one exact retry sentence. Total: ____ / 25. A score below 18 requires a repeat attempt.

Appendix B: Role-Play Scenarios 4–6

Triads: manager, employee or peer, observer. Four minutes for the first conversation, two minutes of feedback, then repeat with stronger language. Score behavior, not charisma.

4. REPEATED LATE HANDOFF

Brief. A colleague's late input affects a cross-functional launch. Practice direct peer-level accountability.

Opening	Labels or vague urgency	Some facts	Observable facts and impact without blame
Inquiry	Tells or rescues	Closed question	Invites perspective before deciding
Standard	"Do better"	Partly specific	CLEAR outcome, authority, and evidence
Commitment	No owner or date	Action but weak follow-up	Owner, action, date, and check-in
Warmth	Avoidant, cold, or overly reassuring	Respectful but uneven	Direct, respectful, confidence-building

Observer instruction

Score each criterion 1–5. Record one effective quote, one missed opportunity, and one exact retry sentence. Total: ____ / 25. A score below 18 requires a repeat attempt.

5. HIGH PERFORMER BYPASSES PROCESS

Brief. Top seller wins business using unapproved discounting. Reset guardrails without diminishing contribution.

Opening	Labels or vague urgency	Some facts	Observable facts and impact without blame
Inquiry	Tells or rescues	Closed question	Invites perspective before deciding
Standard	"Do better"	Partly specific	CLEAR outcome, authority, and evidence
Commitment	No owner or date	Action but weak follow-up	Owner, action, date, and check-in
Warmth	Avoidant, cold, or overly reassuring	Respectful but uneven	Direct, respectful, confidence-building

Observer instruction

Score each criterion 1–5. Record one effective quote, one missed opportunity, and one exact retry sentence. Total: ____ / 25. A score below 18 requires a repeat attempt.

6. EMPLOYEE ASKS FOR MORE AUTONOMY

Brief. A capable employee wants to decide routine exceptions. Practice a staged delegation agreement.

Opening	Labels or vague urgency	Some facts	Observable facts and impact without blame
Inquiry	Tells or rescues	Closed question	Invites perspective before deciding
Standard	"Do better"	Partly specific	CLEAR outcome, authority, and evidence
Commitment	No owner or date	Action but weak follow-up	Owner, action, date, and check-in
Warmth	Avoidant, cold, or overly reassuring	Respectful but uneven	Direct, respectful, confidence-building

Observer instruction

Score each criterion 1–5. Record one effective quote, one missed opportunity, and one exact retry sentence. Total: ____ / 25. A score below 18 requires a repeat attempt.

Appendix B: Role-Play Scenarios 7–9

Triads: manager, employee or peer, observer. Four minutes for the first conversation, two minutes of feedback, then repeat with stronger language. Score behavior, not charisma.

7. BURNOUT RISK AND DECLINING QUALITY

Brief. Team member is missing details and working late. Combine warm inquiry with a standard-preserving workload reset.

Opening	Labels or vague urgency	Some facts	Observable facts and impact without blame
Inquiry	Tells or rescues	Closed question	Invites perspective before deciding
Standard	“Do better”	Partly specific	CLEAR outcome, authority, and evidence
Commitment	No owner or date	Action but weak follow-up	Owner, action, date, and check-in
Warmth	Avoidant, cold, or overly reassuring	Respectful but uneven	Direct, respectful, confidence-building

Observer instruction

Score each criterion 1–5. Record one effective quote, one missed opportunity, and one exact retry sentence. Total: ____ / 25. A score below 18 requires a repeat attempt.

8. NEW MANAGER AVOIDS FEEDBACK

Brief. A supervisor rewrites staff work rather than coaching. Practice a coaching conversation with the supervisor.

Opening	Labels or vague urgency	Some facts	Observable facts and impact without blame
Inquiry	Tells or rescues	Closed question	Invites perspective before deciding
Standard	“Do better”	Partly specific	CLEAR outcome, authority, and evidence
Commitment	No owner or date	Action but weak follow-up	Owner, action, date, and check-in
Warmth	Avoidant, cold, or overly reassuring	Respectful but uneven	Direct, respectful, confidence-building

Observer instruction

Score each criterion 1–5. Record one effective quote, one missed opportunity, and one exact retry sentence. Total: ____ / 25. A score below 18 requires a repeat attempt.

9. ESCALATION WAS TOO LATE

Brief. Project lead waited until deadline to flag a dependency. Practice early-risk language and decision rights.

Opening	Labels or vague urgency	Some facts	Observable facts and impact without blame
Inquiry	Tells or rescues	Closed question	Invites perspective before deciding
Standard	“Do better”	Partly specific	CLEAR outcome, authority, and evidence
Commitment	No owner or date	Action but weak follow-up	Owner, action, date, and check-in
Warmth	Avoidant, cold, or overly reassuring	Respectful but uneven	Direct, respectful, confidence-building

Observer instruction

Score each criterion 1–5. Record one effective quote, one missed opportunity, and one exact retry sentence. Total: ____ / 25. A score below 18 requires a repeat attempt.

Appendix B: Role-Play Scenarios 10–12

Triads: manager, employee or peer, observer. Four minutes for the first conversation, two minutes of feedback, then repeat with stronger language. Score behavior, not charisma.

10. CUSTOMER COMPLAINT TRIGGERS DEFENSIVENESS

Brief. Employee calls the customer unreasonable. Separate facts from emotion and agree next action.

Opening	Labels or vague urgency	Some facts	Observable facts and impact without blame

Inquiry	Tells or rescues	Closed question	Invites perspective before deciding
Standard	“Do better”	Partly specific	CLEAR outcome, authority, and evidence
Commitment	No owner or date	Action but weak follow-up	Owner, action, date, and check-in
Warmth	Avoidant, cold, or overly reassuring	Respectful but uneven	Direct, respectful, confidence-building

Observer instruction

Score each criterion 1–5. Record one effective quote, one missed opportunity, and one exact retry sentence. Total: ____ / 25. A score below 18 requires a repeat attempt.

11. TEAM MEETING HAS NO OWNERSHIP

Brief. Everyone agrees on actions, but no work moves. Practice closing with commitment checks.

Opening	Labels or vague urgency	Some facts	Observable facts and impact without blame
Inquiry	Tells or rescues	Closed question	Invites perspective before deciding
Standard	“Do better”	Partly specific	CLEAR outcome, authority, and evidence
Commitment	No owner or date	Action but weak follow-up	Owner, action, date, and check-in
Warmth	Avoidant, cold, or overly reassuring	Respectful but uneven	Direct, respectful, confidence-building

Observer instruction

Score each criterion 1–5. Record one effective quote, one missed opportunity, and one exact retry sentence. Total: ____ / 25. A score below 18 requires a repeat attempt.

12. BOUNDARY CONVERSATION WITH A PEER LEADER

Brief. Another manager assigns work directly to your team. Practice a respectful boundary and operating agreement.

Opening	Labels or vague urgency	Some facts	Observable facts and impact without blame
Inquiry	Tells or rescues	Closed question	Invites perspective before deciding
Standard	“Do better”	Partly specific	CLEAR outcome, authority, and evidence
Commitment	No owner or date	Action but weak follow-up	Owner, action, date, and check-in
Warmth	Avoidant, cold, or overly reassuring	Respectful but uneven	Direct, respectful, confidence-building

Observer instruction

Score each criterion 1–5. Record one effective quote, one missed opportunity, and one exact retry sentence. Total: ____ / 25. A score below 18 requires a repeat attempt.

Appendix C: Manager Self-Assessment and Scoring Interpretation

Rate each statement 1 = rarely true to 5 = consistently true, based on your behavior under pressure. This is a reflection tool, not a performance rating.

Standards	I state outcome, quality, timing, and evidence in language the team can repeat.	____
Standards	I make decision rights and escalation triggers explicit before work becomes urgent.	____
Warmth	I ask for context before judging a missed commitment.	____
Warmth	People can bring me bad news without being shamed or ignored.	____
Coaching	I address gaps close to the event rather than waiting for a review cycle.	____

Coaching	I use facts and questions before I offer my solution.	____
Ownership	I delegate outcomes with guardrails rather than tasks with hidden control.	____
Ownership	I recognize sound judgment and learning, not only heroic rescue.	____
Rhythm	Our team has a short visible process for priorities, risks, and decisions.	____
Rhythm	We review evidence and adjust the system rather than only asking people to try harder.	____

8–10	Reliable strength	Teach one practice to a peer and protect it in the team rhythm.
5–7	Inconsistent under pressure	Choose one recurring situation and install a visible cue or check-in.
2–4	Likely friction point	Use observer feedback and a one-week behavioral experiment.
Self versus observer	Different scores are useful data	Ask a trusted peer for one example, not a verdict.

Action commitment

Lowest domain: _____ Trigger condition: _____
Behavior I will test: _____ Evidence I will review: _____

Appendix D: Printable Worksheets 1–2

Print these tools or use them as fillable templates. Each field is tied to an observable agreement so managers can revisit evidence instead of relying on memory.

PERFORMANCE FRICTION MAP

Outcome that must be true

Current observable behavior

Customer, team, or capacity impact

Where friction first appears

What is unclear: standard, capability, authority, resource, or rhythm?

Manager conversation to run

Leading evidence in seven days

CLEAR STANDARD BUILDER

Concrete outcome

Level of quality: minimum and excellent

Evidence proving progress or completion

Authority: what the owner can decide

Rhythm: deadline, check-in, escalation trigger

Likely failure mode and prevention

Owner repeats the agreement

Appendix D: Printable Worksheets 3–4

Print these tools or use them as fillable templates. Each field is tied to an observable agreement so managers can revisit evidence instead of relying on memory.

FACT COACHING PLANNER

Facts I can state without labels

Question inviting the other perspective

Clarified standard and impact

Test: next action, support, date

What I will document or follow up

Warmth behavior that does not soften the standard

DELEGATION BRIEF

Outcome and why it matters

Definition of done and evidence

Non-negotiable guardrails

Decision rights granted

Decisions to escalate and trigger

Resources, stakeholders, constraints

Review date and learning questions

Appendix D: Printable Worksheets 5–6

Print these tools or use them as fillable templates. Each field is tied to an observable agreement so managers can revisit evidence instead of relying on memory.

WEEKLY OPERATING RHYTHM

This week’s three outcomes

Owner and next proof point for each

Risks or dependencies to surface early

Decision required and decision maker

Recognition: behavior to name specifically

One system improvement to test

Friday learning review

ACCOUNTABILITY FOLLOW-THROUGH RECORD

Prior agreement and date

Observed result and impact

Employee or peer perspective

Corrective action and support

Next review date and evidence

Consequence or process step if improvement does not occur

Private documentation location or policy reference

Appendix E: Facilitator Agendas and Delivery Notes

Default design: a one-day, practice-heavy workshop for 20–30 participants. Preserve the sequence: diagnose, specify, practice, follow through, and install rhythm.

08:30–08:50	Opening, buyer outcomes, participation agreements	Participants name one team friction; facilitator collects themes.
08:50–09:35	Standards × Warmth and assessment	Pairs identify default pressure behavior; no public score sharing.
09:35–10:30	Friction Map and CLEAR lab	Triads rewrite one vague expectation; peer checks evidence, authority, rhythm.
10:45–11:45	Commitment and FACT coaching	Demonstration, role play, observer rubric.
11:45–12:15	Case clinic 1–4	Groups prepare language and compare to debrief.
13:00–14:00	Accountability without drama	Practice agreement, facts, correction, follow-through; note HR policy boundaries.
14:00–15:00	Delegation and decision rights	Complete delegation brief; peers test for hidden control.
15:15–16:00	Operating rhythms and scorecard	Design a 15-minute weekly rhythm and choose two leading measures.
16:00–16:30	Case clinic 5–8 and 30-day plan	Name friction, experiment, evidence, accountability partner.
16:30–16:45	Close and sponsor handoff	Submit commitments; sponsor receives aggregate themes only.

Virtual adaptation

Use four 90-minute sessions: standards and diagnostic; commitment and coaching; accountability and delegation; rhythm and implementation. Keep breakouts to three, display the rubric before practice, and collect commitments in a shared template.

APPENDIX · HIGH-PERFORMANCE LEADERSHIP SYSTEM

Appendix F: Complete Video Series Outlines and Scripts

Episodes are 6–10 minutes. Each names a friction, teaches one model, demonstrates realistic language, applies one tool, and gives a measurable practice challenge. Provide captions and transcript.

EPISODE 1. WHY GOOD TEAMS DRIFT

Core narration. “When work depends on the manager noticing every problem, the system is telling you something.” Teach Standards × Warmth. Show a vague “be accountable” instruction, then a repeatable CLEAR agreement. Challenge: ask one person to repeat the standard.

State hook and operational consequence.	Explain one model with one visual.	Show poor language, then improved manager language.	Apply tool, issue challenge, preview next episode.

EPISODE 2. DIAGNOSE YOUR PRESSURE PATTERN

Core narration. “Pressure does not invent your habit; it reveals it.” Teach the four quadrants. Show rescue behavior replaced by curious clarity. Challenge: record your first impulse after a miss.

State hook and operational consequence.	Explain one model with one visual.	Show poor language, then improved manager language.	Apply tool, issue challenge, preview next episode.

EPISODE 3. BUILD A CLEAR STANDARD

Core narration. “If two capable people define done differently, the standard is unclear.” Teach Concrete, Level, Evidence, Authority, Rhythm. Demo a customer follow-up agreement. Challenge: rewrite one vague expectation.

State hook and operational consequence.	Explain one model with one visual.	Show poor language, then improved manager language.	Apply tool, issue challenge, preview next episode.

EPISODE 4. CREATE COMMITMENT

Core narration. “Instruction creates motion. Commitment creates ownership.” Teach outcome, perspective, agreement, repeat-back, rhythm. Demo a launch handoff. Challenge: close with “What is your understanding?”

State hook and operational consequence.	Explain one model with one visual.	Show poor language, then improved manager language.	Apply tool, issue challenge, preview next episode.

EPISODE 5. COACH THE GAP WITH FACT

Core narration. “Late feedback turns a small gap into a story about the person.” Teach Facts, Ask, Clarify, Test. Demo missed documentation. Challenge: replace one label with an observable fact.

State hook and operational consequence.	Explain one model with one visual.	Show poor language, then improved manager language.	Apply tool, issue challenge, preview next episode.

EPISODE 6. ACCOUNTABILITY WITHOUT DRAMA

Core narration. “Accountability is follow-through on a known agreement.” Teach sequence and guardrails. Demo a repeated miss after support. Challenge: schedule the review while making the agreement.

State hook and operational consequence.	Explain one model with one visual.	Show poor language, then improved manager language.	Apply tool, issue challenge, preview next episode.

EPISODE 7. DELEGATE FOR OWNERSHIP

Core narration. “If every decision returns to you, you delegated tasks, not ownership.” Teach delegation brief. Demo staged decision rights. Challenge: move one routine decision closer to the work.

State hook and operational consequence.	Explain one model with one visual.	Show poor language, then improved manager language.	Apply tool, issue challenge, preview next episode.

EPISODE 8. MAKE BAD NEWS ARRIVE EARLY

Core narration. “Teams hide risk when speaking up hurts more than the risk.” Teach high warmth, high standards. Demo response to a blocker. Challenge: thank the next risk signal and ask what support is needed.

State hook and operational consequence.	Explain one model with one visual.	Show poor language, then improved manager language.	Apply tool, issue challenge, preview next episode.

EPISODE 9. INSTALL A WEEKLY RHYTHM

Core narration. “More status meetings do not create more ownership.” Teach outcome-risk-decision rhythm. Demo a 15-minute review. Challenge: remove one report item that does not lead to a decision.

State hook and operational consequence.	Explain one model with one visual.	Show poor language, then improved manager language.	Apply tool, issue challenge, preview next episode.

EPISODE 10. MEASURE AND REINFORCE

Core narration. “What gets reviewed becomes real, especially when recognition is specific.” Teach leading and outcome measures. Demo a scorecard review. Challenge: choose one practice measure and one outcome measure.

State hook and operational consequence.	Explain one model with one visual.	Show poor language, then improved manager language.	Apply tool, issue challenge, preview next episode.

Appendix G: Buyer Implementation Roadmap and Governance

Launch against a real business friction, not as a generic leadership event. The roadmap balances adoption with credible measurement and prevents a one-time workshop.

Weeks 0–2: Align	Sponsor defines target population, friction, non-negotiables, baseline. Tailor cases and language.	Sponsor brief, baseline snapshot, participant list, measurement plan.
Weeks 3–4:	Run assessment, workshop or first virtual sessions, first role play.	Participant commitments; aggregate

Launch		confidence; chosen friction.
Weeks 5–8: Practice	Managers run CLEAR, FACT, and delegation experiments. Coaching circles review evidence weekly.	Completed tools, observer feedback, leading-practice measures.
Weeks 9–12: Reinforce	Review scorecard trends, barriers, case clinic, recognition.	Outcome trend review, sponsor checkpoint, adjustments.
Day 90: Sustain	Decide which routines enter onboarding, performance conversations, and team cadence.	Scale recommendation, governance owner, next cohort decision.

Sponsor	Remove cross-functional barriers, model language, review outcomes without demanding confidential reflections.
Manager	Practice one behavior weekly, bring evidence to coaching circles, make agreements visible.
Facilitator	Maintain safety, distinguish training from formal HR guidance, use observer evidence.
Governance group	Ask: Are tools used? Is the first friction improving? What barrier should the sponsor remove?

Buyer readiness check

Business friction: _____ Sponsor: _____ Baseline owner: _____
First cohort: _____ Practice measure: _____ Day-90 decision: _____

Appendix H: Conversation Language Library

Use these phrase patterns as rehearsal material, not scripts to recite mechanically. The pattern is fact, purpose, question, standard, commitment, and rhythm. Managers should adapt wording to their own voice while retaining the operating discipline.

Set a standard	“The outcome we need is ____. The minimum quality is ____. We will know it is complete when ____. What questions or constraints do you see before we agree?”	“Please make this better.”
Start a coaching conversation	“I noticed ____. The impact is ____. Help me understand what happened.”	“You are not being proactive.”
Clarify decision rights	“You can decide ____. Bring me ____. Escalate when ____ happens, not after the deadline.”	“Use your judgment.”
Reset after a miss	“We agreed ____. What occurred was ____. What do we need to change now, and what evidence will we review on ____?”	“This cannot happen again.”
Recognize ownership	“You surfaced the risk early, proposed options, and protected the customer. That is the behavior we want repeated.”	“Good job.”
Say no with warmth	“I understand the request. Given our agreed priorities, we cannot take it on by ____. We can offer ____ or revisit at ____.”	“We are too busy.”
Request a peer correction	“Our agreement was ____. When ____, it created ____. Can we agree to ____ by ____ and check it on ____?”	“Your team always sends this late.”
Close a team meeting	“Owner, outcome, evidence, date, and escalation path: please state your commitment in one sentence.”	“Everyone knows what to do, right?”

Practice rule

Before a difficult conversation, write only the observable facts, the question, the standard, and the next evidence. If you cannot name the evidence, the agreement is not yet complete.

Appendix I: Measurement Library and Scorecard Examples

Choose a small set of measures that can guide improvement, not a dashboard that overwhelms managers. Pair a practice measure, a process measure, and an outcome measure. Review trends with curiosity before assigning a cause.

Clarity	Percentage of sampled assignments with outcome, evidence, authority, and rhythm recorded	Weekly sample of five assignments	Shows whether CLEAR is becoming a habit.
Early risk	Median time from blocker identified to escalation	Risk board or case log	Shows whether bad news arrives soon enough to act.
Coaching	Percentage of significant gaps discussed within five working days	Manager reflection or coaching record	Shows whether feedback is timely.
Ownership	Routine decisions made at the intended level	Decision log sample	Reveals bottlenecks and transfer of authority.
Quality	First-pass acceptance or rework rate	Quality review	Separates speed from reliable execution.
Customer	Relevant response, resolution, onboarding, or satisfaction measure	Operating system	Connects leadership practice to the buyer condition.
Team health	Confidence in standards and speaking up	Short anonymous pulse	Tests warmth and safety without using them as excuses.

What changed?	“Which measure moved, and what do we know rather than assume?”
Where is the earliest signal?	“What risk can we act on before it becomes a customer problem?”
What agreement needs repair?	“Which outcome, authority, or rhythm is currently unclear?”
What behavior should be recognized?	“Who created ownership or surfaced a risk in a way we want repeated?”
What will we test?	“What one change will we make before the next review?”

Measurement guardrail

Do not use one metric to judge a person without context. Use trends, work samples, and conversation. Measures should prompt inquiry and system adjustment, not public ranking or surveillance.

Appendix J: Coaching Circle Guide

Coaching circles turn individual practice into a reinforcement system. Use groups of four to six managers, 45 minutes weekly for the first month and biweekly thereafter. Confidentiality, direct feedback, and real evidence are essential.

1. Case owner frames the friction, 5 minutes	Name the outcome, facts, prior agreement, and decision required. No long background story.
2. Clarifying questions, 7 minutes	Peers ask facts-first questions. They may not give advice until the case owner confirms what is known and unknown.
3. Model selection, 8 minutes	Choose CLEAR, FACT, delegation brief, accountability sequence, or operating rhythm. State why it fits.
4. Language rehearsal, 10 minutes	Case owner practices opening lines. Peers use the observer rubric and offer one exact stronger sentence.
5. Commitment and evidence, 8 minutes	State action, owner, date, support, and evidence. The group checks that decision rights and escalation are explicit.
6. Review of prior commitment, 7 minutes	At next meeting, report result, learning, and what changed. Celebrate follow-through and name unfinished work without shame.

Advice avalanche	“Pause. What fact or question would help the case owner think?”
Therapy instead of operating issue	“What is the observable work condition and agreement?”
Vague commitment	“Who will do what by when, and what will prove it?”

Manager rescuing	“What authority can move to the person closest to the work?”
No follow-through	“Bring the evidence, not a summary of intention.”

Appendix K: 30-Day Manager Practice Calendar

Run one small behavioral experiment each week. The calendar uses live work, not simulated activity, and requires visible evidence. If an experiment fails, capture the learning and adjust the agreement.

Week 1: See the system	Complete self-assessment; map one recurring friction; sample three assignments for CLEAR elements.	One-page friction map and one rewritten standard.
Week 2: Create commitment	Run two expectation-setting conversations using repeat-back and decision rights.	Two documented agreements; employee or peer confirms understanding.
Week 3: Coach and delegate	Run one FACT conversation and one delegation brief. Ask an observer for feedback.	Observer rubric plus next action, support, and review date.
Week 4: Install rhythm	Lead a 15-minute outcome-risk-decision review. Examine measures and recognize one ownership behavior.	Visible board, one metric trend, one system improvement decision.
Day 30 review	Compare the original friction to current evidence. Decide continue, adapt, or escalate.	Sponsor or peer check-in; next 30-day plan.

Before assigning work	“Can the person state the outcome, evidence, authority, and rhythm?”
When a miss occurs	“What are the facts, what is their perspective, and what standard must remain?”
When a risk is raised	“How can I thank the signal and remove the barrier without taking back ownership?”
Before ending a meeting	“Can every owner state their next proof point and escalation path?”
At the end of the week	“What did our system make easy, and what did it make hard?”

Accountability partner

Partner: _____ Check-in date: _____ Evidence I will bring: _____ One behavior they will observe: _____

Appendix L: Buyer Sponsor Briefing and Change Risks

Use this briefing before launch and at the 30-, 60-, and 90-day checkpoints. It helps sponsors create the conditions for practice rather than treating leadership development as a standalone event.

No real friction selected	Participants enjoy the tools but cannot apply them.	Select one recurring customer, quality, handoff, or decision problem before launch.
Sponsors demand outcomes too quickly	Managers revert to pressure and concealment.	Review leading behaviors at 30 days; reserve outcome conclusions for a credible trend.
Managers lack time or authority	Practice becomes homework and ownership remains impossible.	Remove one low-value reporting task and clarify decision rights for the first experiment.
Training conflicts with HR policy	Managers improvise formal performance actions.	State boundaries; route formal employee-relations matters through policy and qualified partners.
Measurement becomes surveillance	People game metrics or stop surfacing risk.	Use samples and trends for learning; never publish individual comparisons without purpose and context.
No reinforcement	Workshop language fades after the	Use coaching circles, a sponsor checkpoint, and a manager

mechanism	event.	operating rhythm.

Day 0	“What friction are we solving, what would credible improvement look like, and what baseline do we have?”
Day 30	“What tools are managers using in live work? What barrier should I remove?”
Day 60	“What leading measures moved, what did we learn, and what needs adaptation?”
Day 90	“Which practice belongs in onboarding and operating cadence? What is the next cohort decision?”

Sponsor commitment

I will model one clear agreement, protect time for practice, ask for evidence without blame, and remove the barrier that managers cannot remove themselves.

Appendix M: Facilitator Troubleshooting and FAQ

Use this guide during delivery and reinforcement. The goal is not perfect facilitation language. It is to maintain a practice environment where managers can examine real work, receive useful feedback, and leave with a credible next action.

“Our context is too complex for a simple model.”	Acknowledge complexity, then ask which part is unclear: outcome, quality, authority, resource, or rhythm. The models reduce ambiguity; they do not deny complexity.	Ask the group to make one complex example observable enough to test next week.
“We already have KPIs.”	Measures are not management agreements. Ask whether people can state what good looks like, who may decide, and when a risk should be raised.	Use one KPI as an outcome measure and add one practice measure.
“I cannot hold people accountable because morale is low.”	Low morale is a reason to increase clarity, respect, and support, not to remove standards. Avoid promising that one conversation solves capacity or systemic issues.	Practice a FACT opening that names the impact and invites the person’s reality.
“My team is different.”	Invite a tailored example, but prevent the claim from becoming an exit from practice. Every team still has outcomes, decisions, risk signals, and follow-through.	Assign the participant to adapt one worksheet field to their environment.
A participant dominates discussion.	Thank the contribution, summarize it, then direct a specific question to quieter participants or use pairs before plenary discussion.	Use a visible timebox and rotate reporter roles.
A participant shares a sensitive employee case.	Keep the learning at the level of behavior and agreements. Do not diagnose, promise formal outcomes, or invite identifiable details.	Remind the group of confidentiality and route formal matters through policy.
Role plays feel artificial.	Use current, low-risk work and allow participants to choose manager or peer roles. Make the first attempt intentionally imperfect.	Require one exact retry sentence after observer feedback.
Managers ask for a universal script.	Offer the language pattern, not a false promise of a single phrase that works everywhere. Facts, question, standard, commitment, and rhythm remain adaptable.	Have participants replace generic wording with their own business language.
The sponsor wants a fast report.	Provide aggregate adoption, themes, practice evidence, and leading measures. Do not expose individual reflection or role-play performance.	Offer a 30-day sponsor checkpoint with a decision list.
No one completes the worksheets after training.	Reduce the first assignment to one live friction, one tool, and one evidence review. Attach it to an existing management rhythm.	Have each manager schedule the action before leaving the session.

Escalation boundary

Training can strengthen manager skill, but it does not replace HR, legal, clinical, safety, or employee-relations guidance. When a case crosses that boundary, pause the exercise, protect privacy, and use the organization’s established route.

Appendix N: Implementation Frequently Asked Questions

These answers help buyers, sponsors, and facilitators set realistic expectations. The product is designed to improve the management system around daily work. It should be tailored to local policies, measures, and operating language.

Who should attend?	Frontline managers, new people leaders, team leads, and influential individual contributors who coordinate work.

	Mixed cohorts work when examples are adapted and decision rights are made explicit.
What cohort size works best?	Twelve to twenty-four supports rehearsal and observer feedback. Larger cohorts can work with trained table facilitators, structured breakouts, and preselected cases.
How much prework is needed?	Ask participants to bring one recurring friction and complete the self-assessment. Sponsors should provide the target population, relevant operating measures, and any policy boundaries.
Can this be delivered virtually?	Yes. Use four 90-minute sessions, small breakouts, digital worksheets, and a shared commitment board. Virtual design needs more frequent practice and shorter explanations.
How is success measured?	Start with adoption: use of CLEAR, FACT, delegation brief, and weekly rhythm. Then examine relevant process and outcome trends such as rework, escalation timing, cycle time, quality, or customer experience.
What should leaders do after the workshop?	Run coaching circles, protect a weekly review rhythm, observe one live conversation or work sample, and remove the system barrier that managers cannot solve themselves.
Does the program address poor performance?	It builds skill for timely, fair conversations and follow-through. Formal performance management remains governed by organizational policy and qualified HR or legal guidance.
How much customization is appropriate?	Customize cases, terminology, examples, and measures. Preserve the core models and practice design so customization does not make the program vague or buyer-specific in a way that cannot scale.
What makes adoption fail?	Launching without a real friction, asking managers to practice without time or authority, overmeasuring, or treating the workshop as the intervention rather than the start of reinforcement.
What does a successful 90-day decision look like?	A sponsor can point to an adopted management rhythm, examples of better agreements or earlier risk signals, a credible trend in the target friction, and a decision about how to scale or adapt the program.

Buyer decision checklist

Target friction selected: ____ Sponsor named: ____ Baseline available: ____ Policy boundaries clear: ____
Practice rhythm scheduled: ____ 30/60/90 checkpoints booked: ____ Scale decision owner: ____

Appendix O: Leadership System Field Guide

Use this field guide as a quick reference during facilitation, coaching circles, and manager preparation. Terms should lead to observable behavior and decisions, not become new jargon.

Accountability	A known agreement plus visible follow-through. It is not surprise, shaming, or a substitute for clear expectations.
Authority	The decisions a person may make without approval. Authority must be stated before urgency, not discovered during it.
Capability	Knowledge, skill, capacity, or resources needed to meet a standard. Diagnose it before assuming motivation is the issue.
CLEAR	Concrete outcome, Level of quality, Evidence, Authority, Rhythm. A method for making work executable.
Commitment	An owner restates the outcome, action, date, and evidence in their own words.
Decision rights	Who recommends, decides, approves, or must be consulted. Hidden decision rights create delay and false escalation.
Definition of done	The evidence proving the work is complete and usable, not merely started or sent.
Escalation trigger	A specified condition that requires help or a higher-level decision. It protects speed and reduces fear of bad news.
FACT	Facts, Ask, Clarify, Test. A coaching pattern for timely, respectful correction.
Friction	A recurring point where work slows, fails, is reworked, or depends on heroics. Friction is a system signal.
High warmth	Respect, curiosity, fairness, support, recognition, and confidence in people's ability to succeed.
High standards	Explicit outcomes, quality, timing, decision rights, and credible follow-through.
Leading measure	Evidence that a desired behavior or process is occurring before an outcome trend appears.
Operating rhythm	A repeatable cadence for priorities, risks, decisions, evidence, and learning.
Ownership	The ability and responsibility to make meaningful progress within clear guardrails, not merely to complete assigned tasks.
Practice evidence	A work sample, observer note, agreement, or measure demonstrating behavior, rather than a self-report of intention.

Psychological safety	A condition where people can raise risks, questions, or mistakes without humiliation. It supports, not replaces, standards.
Rework	Effort required because the first pass did not meet the agreed standard. Use it to improve the system, not to assign blame.
Review rhythm	The date and method used to inspect evidence, learn, adjust, and decide whether an agreement is working.
Warmth without standards	Good intent with weak follow-through. The corrective move is clearer agreement, not less respect.

Fast diagnostic: When work is unreliable, ask in order: What outcome must be true? What evidence shows it? Who can decide? What risk should be raised when? What support or system constraint makes the standard hard to meet? What date will we review?
THE HIGH-PERFORMANCE LEADERSHIP SYSTEM

References and Source Notes

Canonical product source: *High_Performance_Leadership_Training_Product.md*, vault leadership and management media collection. The Standards × Warmth model is used as a practical learning framework; tailor examples, organizational policies, and measures to the buyer environment.

Deci, E. L., Olafsen, A. H., & Ryan, R. M. (2017). Self-determination theory in work organizations: The state of a science. *Annual Review of Organizational Psychology and Organizational Behavior, 4*, 19–43.

Edmondson, A. (1999). Psychological safety and learning behavior in work teams. *Administrative Science Quarterly, 44*(2), 350–383.

Gallup. (2024). *State of the Global Workplace: 2024 Report.* Gallup Press.

Hattie, J., & Timperley, H. (2007). The power of feedback. *Review of Educational Research, 77*(1), 81–112.

Locke, E. A., & Latham, G. P. (2002). Building a practically useful theory of goal setting and task motivation. *American Psychologist, 57*(9), 705–717.

Note for facilitators: These sources support the general learning design. They do not replace legal, HR, clinical, or employee-relations guidance. Adapt accountability sequences to local policy and seek appropriate expert support for formal performance matters.

Final commitment

The leadership behavior I will practice first: _____

The team outcome it will support: _____

The evidence I will review on: _____

HOW TO USE THE EVIDENCE

Edmondson (1999)	Support early risk reporting, questions, and learning from work.	Safety is not lower standards or avoidance of consequences.
Locke & Latham (2002)	Make goals specific, challenging, and connected to feedback.	Goals still require resources, decision rights, and quality measures.
Hattie & Timperley (2007)	Use feedback about task, process, and next action.	Do not turn feedback into labels about personality.
Deci et al. (2017)	Build autonomy, competence, and relatedness through manager practice.	Autonomy requires guardrails and an appropriate level of support.
Gallup (2024)	Frame manager capability as an organizational performance condition.	Do not claim a training program alone causes engagement or business outcomes.

Source-use note: These references inform the program design and facilitation choices. They are not presented as proof that every buyer will achieve the same result. Baseline conditions, leadership sponsorship, policy alignment, capacity, and sustained practice all affect outcomes.

RESEARCH-TO-PRACTICE DISCUSSION GUIDE

How do standards become motivating rather than controlling?	Managers connect a specific outcome to customer, team, or mission impact; define evidence and authority; ask for constraints; and follow through on the agreement. They do not rely on pressure or hidden expectations.
What does psychological safety look like in a high-accountability team?	People can raise a risk, ask for clarification, or admit a miss early. The manager responds with facts, curiosity, support, and an unchanged standard. Problems are surfaced earlier because the response is useful rather than humiliating.
How should a manager use feedback?	Feedback is timely, specific, connected to task or process, and points toward a next action. The manager tests understanding, identifies support, and sets a review date instead of ending with a general warning or

	personality label.
How does autonomy become reliable ownership?	Autonomy is paired with capability, meaningful decision rights, guardrails, and a review rhythm. The manager delegates an outcome, not a vague task, then reviews evidence without reclaiming every decision.
What should sponsors review at 30 days?	Evidence that managers are using the tools in real work, one barrier that requires sponsor action, early signals from the target friction, and a decision about how practice will enter the normal operating cadence.

Facilitator close

Use the evidence to improve the next management conversation, not to win an argument. Ask participants to choose one operating condition they can influence this week: clarify an outcome, move a decision right, invite an early risk, give feedback on observable work, or install a review rhythm. The practice becomes credible when the manager can show the agreement, the evidence, and the learning from the next review.

Reflection questions: Which assumption about people or performance is this tool helping us test? What data would change our view? Where are we asking a manager to compensate for a system constraint? What decision or resource is needed from a sponsor?

EVIDENCE-INFORMED PRACTICE MOVES

Vague work requests	Convert the request into a CLEAR agreement and ask the owner to repeat it.	Outcome, quality level, decision right, date, and proof point are visible.
Late surprises	Name the escalation trigger, thank the signal, and repair the review rhythm.	Time from risk identified to escalation; quality of recovery options.
Repeated rescue	Use a delegation brief and move one routine decision to the intended owner.	Decision samples, rework rate, and manager time released from routine approval.
A performance miss	Use FACT while the details are current; distinguish capacity, skill, system, and agreement gaps.	Specific next action, support, review date, and a documented prior agreement.
Silence in meetings	Ask a facts-first question, invite dissent, and show what changed after a risk was raised.	Number and timing of risks raised; team pulse on clarity and speaking up.
Strong individual output but weak bench strength	Recognize teaching and decision transfer, not only expert intervention.	Decisions made at intended level, cross-training progress, and succession readiness.
Metric pressure without learning	Review trends with curiosity; choose one system experiment before assigning a cause.	Trend, work samples, participant insight, and the next test rather than a single score.